CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 10

Marlo Quince

MASTER CHANDLER OF CANDLEWICK HALL

"Twenty years at the wax vats. You know how every candle in this house was made."



FOR MARLO QUINCE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A long black cloak or dark bathrobe and a paper crown of candle flames cut from yellow card. Dot gold face paint across your cheeks.

Mask: a plain black eye mask, or two eye holes cut in a cereal box and tied with ribbon.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are the culprit.

You put sleep drops in Vesper's cider. Nobody must find out. You are the only player who may lie outright.

Your cover story: You never left the Dipping Room between 8:15 and nine o'clock. You were dipping tapers for the Costume Parade the whole time.

BACKGROUND

You came to the candle works as a teenager and never left. Two winters ago, with the roof leaking and your pay cut, you quietly sold the Hall's six antique brass candle molds to Hollow Antiques for $1,800 and put painted copies in the display case. Nobody noticed. Then this week an appraiser visited, and this afternoon Vesper took you aside: "Tell everyone the truth at nine, or I will."

WHAT REALLY HAPPENED

At 8:20 you snuffed the hour candle in the Dipping Room and, out of habit, chalked "Out 8:20" on the slate. You went up the Back Stairs to the Coat Room, took the fox mask Jory had just left on hook 3 and a bottle of sleep drops from Briar's sewing bag on hook 5. At the gallery's little cider kettle, where Vesper always leaves the pumpkin cup for a refill, you filled the cup, added the drops and, in your black cloak and the fox mask, carried it to Vesper at about 8:35. Vesper thought you were Jory and said, "Oh, thank you." You hurried back down the Back Stairs, pushed the mask and the empty bottle under the wax shavings in the Stockroom bin, and chalked "Back 8:45."

YOUR GOALS

- Keep suspicion away from yourself until the ballots are in.
- Point people toward Jory (it was Jory's fox mask), Briar (the sleep drops) and Darcy (the heir, also in gold face paint).
- Win the Best Bluffer award.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Use true details wherever you can. You may lie about yourself and your movements, but you may never change what an evidence card says. Stay friendly, stay calm and enjoy it.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You have been giving candle-dipping demonstrations in the Dipping Room since 8:00. At the 8:15 toast Vesper looked tense and said to you, "Nine o'clock, Marlo." Tell people you took that to mean the announcement. Mention that you saw Jory's orange fox mask hanging in the Coat Room earlier this evening.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Where was your fox mask at half past eight?"
- Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "What did you and Vesper argue about after the toast?"

YOUR TASK

> Get two people to tell you, out loud, exactly where they were at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Tell people that this afternoon Briar complained about not sleeping and said they keep sleep drops in that patchwork sewing bag. Say the Lantern Ghost has been seen every Halloween for years, and that Perry always seems to be nearby when it appears.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Briar Fallow:** "What do you keep in the patchwork sewing bag on hook 5?"
- Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "What were you doing on a stepladder outside the gallery windows?"

YOUR TASK

> Persuade one player that the Lantern Ghost had something to do with Vesper's cup.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

When the fox mask (Evidence #9) comes out, point out that Darcy wears gold face paint too. If anyone asks about the slate (Evidence #10), say you popped next door to the Stockroom for fresh wax for a few minutes, and that anyone could have chalked on that slate.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Are you sure it was a fox mask you saw, and not some other orange mask?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Who in this house has a key to the Back Stairs door?"

YOUR TASK

> Cast your ballot for someone else, and stay perfectly calm until Script 5 is read.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 11

Darcy Wickliffe

VESPER'S YOUNGER COUSIN AND HEIR

"Everyone calls you the heir. Nobody ever asks whether you want the job."



FOR DARCY WICKLIFFE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

"The Golden Sun": yellow or gold clothes and a sunburst of paper rays around your face. Dot gold face paint freckles across your nose.

Mask: a gold paper half mask, or yellow card with two eye holes.

BRING TO THE BALL

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- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

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THE BALL

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Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

You love Candlewick Hall, but you have never wanted to run it. Your bicycle repair shop in the Hollow closed in the spring and left you owing $4,000. You have told nobody, not even Vesper, until tonight.

YOUR SECRET

Right after the 8:15 toast you asked Vesper, quietly, by the ballroom doors, for a loan. Vesper said, “Not tonight, Darcy. After nine you’ll understand.” You are afraid the announcement cuts you out of the Hall altogether, and people saw your face fall.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

At 8:15 you heard the toast. From 8:30 to 8:45 you stood in the Costume Parade line-up on the ballroom stage as entrant No. 2 and never left it. At about 8:48 you saw the Lantern Ghost through the ballroom windows. At 9:00 you and Hadley went to fetch Vesper and found Vesper asleep in the window chair, the pumpkin cup on the sill. Vesper never woke up.

YOUR GOALS

- Prove you never left the stage line between 8:30 and 8:45.
- Keep the loan and your debt quiet until Round 2.
- Find out what Vesper was going to announce.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You saw the Lantern Ghost at about 8:48 from the stage: a small light drifting past the gallery windows, one after another, then gone. At 9:00 you and Hadley found Vesper in the window chair with the pumpkin cup on the sill. Tell people Vesper seemed distracted at the toast. Keep the loan to yourself for now.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- ? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Where were you working tonight, and did anyone keep you company?"
- ? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Why were you already near the gallery when we went to fetch Vesper?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who wore a fox mask tonight, and who else wore a long black cloak.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Admit the argument: after the toast you asked Vesper for a loan, and Vesper said, "Not tonight. After nine you'll understand." Point out that the parade line-up sheet (Evidence #7) shows you on the stage from 8:30 to 8:45. Entrants were not allowed to leave the line.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- ? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Who could have known your mask was hanging on hook 3?"
- ? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Do the letters "Pe" on that torn supply slip stand for you?"

YOUR TASK

> Get Briar to confirm out loud that you never left the stage line.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Three people have their own key to the Back Stairs door: you (family), Marlo (the workshop keys) and Perry (the lantern keys). You have never heard of Hollow Antiques. Last month Vesper told you, "Marlo dusts those brass molds every week. Nobody else touches them."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Who looks after the brass molds in the display case?"

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "What else did Vesper's notes for nine o'clock say?"

YOUR TASK

Look closely at everyone's gold face paint. Whose is smudged around the eyes?

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

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19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 12

Perry *Lanthorn*

LANTERN-MAKER WHO LIGHTS THE LANTERN GALLERY

"You light a hundred lanterns every Halloween. Tonight one of them lit itself."



FOR PERRY LANTHORN'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A long coat or raincoat, a woolly scarf and a lantern to carry (a flashlight in a jar works). Pin a paper moth to your shoulder.

Mask: a moth-wing mask cut from brown paper or a grocery bag.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

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Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

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THE BALL

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Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

Last week Vesper told you that when the Hall becomes a museum, the real lanterns in the gallery will be replaced with electric bulbs. Eleven years of lantern nights, gone.

YOUR SECRET

You are the Lantern Ghost, and you have been every Halloween for eleven years: a battery tea light in a tiny lantern, sliding along clear fishing line from window one to window nine, pulled by hand from the terrace. Tonight you flew it one last time, hoping a famous ghost sighting in the Hollow Gazette would save the real lanterns.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:25 you were on a stepladder on the terrace outside the gallery windows, tying the line (the Gazette camera photographed you at 8:30 and 8:36). Jory was lighting jack-o'-lanterns beside you. At 8:36, through window seven, you saw Vesper sipping from the pumpkin cup, and someone in a long black cloak hurrying away up the gallery toward the Back Stairs. You only saw their back. At 8:48 you flew the ghost.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the Lantern Ghost secret until Round 3.
- Make sure everyone hears what you saw through window seven.
- Save the real lanterns of the gallery.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were out on the terrace from 8:25, checking the gallery window latches (that is all you will say for now). Jory was there too, lighting the row of jack-o'-lanterns without a mask on. Tell people the Lantern Ghost is real: you have seen it every year for eleven years.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you see anyone go in or out of the gallery while you were lighting pumpkins?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Which guests wore long black cloaks tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Persuade one person that the Lantern Ghost is real.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Yes, you were on a stepladder (Evidence #6). Now share what you saw at 8:36 through window seven: Vesper sipping from the pumpkin cup, and someone in a long black cloak hurrying away up the gallery toward the Back Stairs door. At that moment Hadley stood at the far, ballroom end of the gallery with a notebook. Hadley and the cloak were two different people.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "What did the person who carried the cup look like?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did Vesper ever mention electric lights for the gallery?"

YOUR TASK

> Keep the ghost secret one more round. Change the subject if anyone waves Evidence #4 or #8 at you.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess: you are the Lantern Ghost, and have been for eleven years. The fishing line (Evidence #4) and the torn supply slip signed "Pe" (Evidence #8) are yours. Explain why: the real lanterns. The ghost flew at 8:48, after Vesper had already taken the cup. It has nothing to do with what happened to Vesper.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "You hold the workshop keys. Who else uses the Back Stairs door?"

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "When did you notice that your fox mask was gone?"

YOUR TASK

> Win a round of applause for the Lantern Ghost.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

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13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

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19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 13

Briar *Fallow*

COSTUME MAKER OF CANDLEWICK HOLLOW

"You stitched half the costumes in this ballroom. You know exactly who is wearing what."



FOR BRIAR FALLOW'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

An apron, a tape measure around your neck and a ribbon full of safety pins. A sponge on an elastic makes a pincushion bracelet.

Mask: a lace half mask, or a paper doily with two eye holes.

BRING TO THE BALL

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

Big nights keep you awake, so you carry sleep drops from your doctor in your patchwork sewing bag. Tonight the bag hung on hook 5 in the Coat Room. You also have a professional secret.

YOUR SECRET

This year you secretly sewed the costumes of four Costume Parade entrants. Vesper, the judge, warned last week that any "shop-bought" entry would be disqualified and the costume maker named at nine o'clock. You were sure the announcement was about you.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

At 8:24 you fetched pins from your sewing bag in the Coat Room and saw Jory hang the fox mask on hook 3 and pin a note. From 8:30 to 8:45 you were on the ballroom stage pinning hems for the line-up, and never left. At about 9:10 you noticed the sleep drops were missing from your bag.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep your four secret costumes quiet until Round 3.
- Find out who took your sleep drops.
- Make sure nobody blames Jory for the fox mask.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You made Jory's fox mask: orange felt, one of a kind. At 8:24 you were in the Coat Room fetching pins and saw Jory hang the fox mask on hook 3 and pin a note to it. Tell people you don't do face paint, ever: tonight's painted faces were done at home.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Why did you take your fox mask off?"

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Were you in the Lantern Gallery before nine?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out which suspects were not at the Costume Parade line-up between 8:30 and 8:45.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

The line-up sheet (Evidence #7) is right: you and Darcy were on the stage the whole time, 8:30 to 8:45. Admit that your patchwork sewing bag on hook 5 (Evidence #3) holds your sleep drops, prescribed by your doctor. At 9:10 you found the bottle gone. Keep your secret costumes to yourself.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did you come up to the Coat Room at any point this evening?"

? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Why were you on the terrace instead of in the ballroom?"

YOUR TASK

> Make a list of everyone wearing a long black cloak tonight.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess your four secret costumes. Then explain the fox mask (Evidence #9): face paint rubs off inside a mask when it is pressed on, so the last person to wear it had gold face paint on. Only two guests wore gold face paint tonight: Darcy and Marlo. The empty bottle is yours.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did you ever take off your sunburst or your gold half mask tonight?"

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Your gold face paint looks smudged around the eyes. What happened?"

YOUR TASK

Ask the Detective to keep your sleep-drops bottle safe as evidence.

Notes

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21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 14

Jory *Greaves*

PUMPKIN FARMER AND THREE-TIME CARVING CHAMPION

"Three carving trophies, one fox mask, and an alibi made of pumpkins."



FOR JORY GREAVES'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

An orange sweater or hoodie with a black cloak or blanket over your shoulders. Carry a toy pumpkin or a real small one.

Mask: a fox mask: orange card or felt with two pointed ears.

BRING TO THE BALL

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

Your family has farmed the Hall's south field for forty years. Last week Vesper told you the field would become parking for the new museum. You shouted at Vesper in the pumpkin patch, and the whole market heard.

YOUR SECRET

Two days ago, angry and worried, you signed a deal to sell this year's entire pumpkin crop to the rival Ember Falls festival, not to Candlewick Hollow. Nobody here knows.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

At 8:25 the fox mask fogged up while you were carving, so you hung it on hook 3 in the Coat Room and pinned a note to the hook. Briar was beside you, fetching pins from the sewing bag on hook 5. From 8:25 to 8:50 you were on the terrace lighting the jack-o'-lanterns, bare-faced (the Gazette camera caught you at 8:30 and 8:36). Perry was on a stepladder nearby. At 8:52 you went back for the mask. The hook was empty.

YOUR GOALS

- Prove you were on the terrace, not in the gallery.
- Find out who took your fox mask.
- Keep the Ember Falls deal quiet until Round 3.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Your fox mask: you left it on hook 3 in the Coat Room at 8:25 with a note (Evidence #3), and when you went back at 8:52 it was gone. From 8:25 to 8:50 you were outside on the terrace lighting the jack-o'-lanterns. Keep the field and the Ember Falls deal to yourself.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Did you see anyone near the Coat Room hooks after 8:25?"

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did you come up from the Dipping Room at all tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Find someone who saw your fox mask after 8:25.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

The Gazette photos (Evidence #6) prove you were on the terrace, bare-faced, at 8:30 and 8:36. You saw Perry on a stepladder by the gallery windows, fiddling with something thin and shiny, and Perry asked you not to mention it. Admit that Vesper told you last week your field would become museum parking.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "What were you tying to the gallery windows?"

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Which way did the person in the fox mask walk?"

YOUR TASK

> Get someone to admit that they have a key to the Back Stairs door.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the Ember Falls deal. Then point out where your mask turned up (Evidence #9): in the Stockroom bin, at the foot of the Back Stairs, on the workshop floor. You have not been downstairs all night, and you wore no face paint at all.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "The Stockroom is right next to the Dipping Room. Did you hear anyone in there around 8:40?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Where did you get your gold face paint, and who else used it?"

YOUR TASK

> Ask the Detective for your fox mask back. (It's evidence. You can't have it.)

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 15

Hadley Cresswell

EDITOR OF THE HOLLOW GAZETTE

"Every story in the Hollow crosses your desk. Tonight's was meant to be an exclusive."



FOR HADLEY CRESSWELL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A trench coat or long cardigan, a press card on a lanyard and a pencil behind your ear. Carry a small notebook.

Mask: a black half mask with PRESS written across the top in white.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

Vesper promised you the story first, “after nine.” You have never been good at waiting.

YOUR SECRET

At 8:10 you slipped into Vesper’s study off the Lantern Gallery and read the notes for nine o’clock on the desk. They said the Hall goes to the town as a Lantern Museum, that the six brass candle molds in the display case are fakes, and that “whoever sold them has until nine to tell me.”

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

You heard the 8:15 toast. From 8:30 to 8:38 you stood at the ballroom end of the Lantern Gallery, writing in your notebook. Outside the windows, Perry was up a stepladder fiddling with a latch. At about 8:35 you saw someone in a long black cloak and a fox mask carry a steaming pumpkin cup from the Back Stairs end down to Vesper’s chair. Vesper said, “Oh, thank you.” The figure said nothing and walked back toward the Back Stairs. At 9:00 you and Darcy found Vesper.

YOUR GOALS

- Make sure everyone hears what you saw at 8:35.
- Keep your visit to the study quiet until Round 2.
- Get the real story for the Gazette.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

At about 8:35 you were at the ballroom end of the Lantern Gallery and saw someone in a long black cloak and a fox mask carry a steaming pumpkin cup from the Back Stairs end to Vesper's window chair. Vesper took it and said, "Oh, thank you." The figure said nothing and walked back toward the Back Stairs. Don't say why you were there.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- ? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Where were you at 8:35?"
- ? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "What did Vesper say to you after the toast?"

YOUR TASK

> Interview three suspects for the Gazette and write down one quote from each.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

The Gazette's terrace camera took the photos in Evidence #6, one every six minutes. Admit that at 8:10 you slipped into Vesper's study and read the notes for nine o'clock: the Hall goes to the town as a Lantern Museum. Keep the rest of the notes to yourself for now.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- ? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "What were you holding on that stepladder?"
- ? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Who was in the parade line-up the whole time?"

YOUR TASK

> Get one suspect to give you an "official statement" for the front page.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Now share the rest of Vesper's notes, which match Evidence #11: the six brass candle molds in the display case are fakes, an appraiser comes on November 1, and "whoever sold them has until nine to tell me." Whoever carried that cup at 8:35 walked like someone who knew the house.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Who in this house could tell a fake candle mold from a real one?"

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you wear your fox mask at all after 8:25?"

YOUR TASK

> Write tomorrow's Gazette headline on the back of your ballot.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

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20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 16

Auden *Pryor*

TOWN HISTORIAN AND KEEPER OF THE LANTERN GHOST LEGEND

"You know every legend in the Hollow. Tonight you met a new one."



FOR AUDEN PRYOR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 7+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A tweed jacket or cardigan, a scarf and an old book under your arm. Add a pair of glasses without lenses.

Mask: a brown paper owl mask with big round eyes.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

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THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks. You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

You have spent ten years writing a history of the candle works. Vesper refused to let you borrow the Hall's archive.

YOUR SECRET

Last spring you borrowed the 1890 candle-works ledger from the library without asking and never put it back. You were afraid the museum appraiser would notice it missing.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were alone in the library, putting the ledger back on its shelf before anyone noticed. At 8:48 you heard guests shout about the ghost and ran to the ballroom.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the borrowed ledger quiet until Round 2.
- Tell the Lantern Ghost legend to anyone who will listen.
- Find out what the museum plan means for the archive.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Tell everyone the legend: every Halloween since the candle works opened, one lantern drifts along the gallery windows, from the first to the last, then winks out. People say it is the first chandler of the Hall checking every wick. Say you were reading in the library from 8:20 until the shouting at 8:48.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Have you ever seen the Lantern Ghost up close?"
- Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Will the Gazette print the legend this year?"

YOUR TASK

> Tell the legend to at least two people who haven't heard it.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Admit you borrowed the 1890 ledger last spring and slipped it back tonight. It lists six brass candle molds, made in 1890, each stamped with a small crescent moon. You can tell a real one from a copy by that moon.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Do the molds in the display case still have their crescent-moon stamps?"
- Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did Vesper ever let anyone take things out of the Hall?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who was in the Lantern Gallery between 8:30 and 8:40.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

The real molds would be worth a great deal to a collector, perhaps $1,800 for the six. A copy good enough to fool the town for two years must have been made by someone very handy with molds and wax.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "What did Vesper say about the museum when you two argued?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Could you have made a copy of a brass mold?"

YOUR TASK

> Decide whether the Lantern Ghost is real, and say so out loud.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

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19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

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21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 17

Bexley *Applegate*

OWNER OF THE APPLEGATE CIDER PRESS



"You pour every cup of cider at the ball. You remember every cup."

FOR BEXLEY APPLEGATE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 8+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A flannel shirt or plaid scarf and an apron. Tuck a ladle or a wooden spoon in your pocket.

Mask: a red paper apple mask with a green leaf at the top.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

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Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

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THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

> **If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.** You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

The museum plan includes a museum café with its own cider supplier. Your biggest customer is about to disappear.

YOUR SECRET

This year's crop failed, so tonight's "Applegate pressed" cider is store-bought juice with your spices. You would hate anyone to know.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:00 to 9:00 you were at the cider urn in the front hall. At 8:20 you filled Vesper's pumpkin cup yourself. Nobody in a fox mask came to your urn. At 8:00 you had topped up the gallery kettle; anyone in the gallery could pour from it.

YOUR GOALS

- Make sure people know the urn cider was fine.
- Keep the store-bought juice quiet until Round 3.
- Find out who used the gallery kettle.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You filled Vesper's pumpkin cup yourself at 8:20, from the urn in the front hall. Vesper carried it off toward the gallery. Nobody in a fox mask came to your urn all evening. Only Vesper was given a pumpkin cup.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did Vesper drink cider at the toast, or save it for later?"

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you want a cup of cider tonight? You never came to the urn."

YOUR TASK

> Offer three people a (pretend or real) cup of cider and ask where they were at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

There is a second source of hot cider: the little kettle on its warmer in an alcove of the Lantern Gallery, near the Back Stairs end. You topped it up at 8:00. Vesper always leaves the empty pumpkin cup beside that kettle for a refill. A steaming cup at 8:35 must have come from there.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Was the cup steaming when you saw it?"

? Ask **Auden Pryor:** "You were near the gallery. Did you see anyone at the kettle?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who knew about the gallery kettle.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess that the cider is store-bought juice this year. Then say the gallery kettle was half empty at 9:15, though Vesper only ever drinks one cup.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did you ever pour from the gallery kettle?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Where do you keep your sleep drops, and who knew?"

YOUR TASK

> Persuade the room to toast Vesper with a cup of cider after the reveal.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

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20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 18

Corin *Thimble*

FIDDLER AND LEADER OF THE BALL'S BAND

"From the musicians' balcony you see the whole ballroom. Almost."



FOR CORIN THIMBLE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 9+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A waistcoat or vest, a bow tie made of ribbon and a toy violin (or a ruler for a bow).

Mask: a black-and-white piano-key mask drawn on card.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

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Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

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Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

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THE BALL

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Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks. You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper told the band last month that the museum would have "recorded music only."

YOUR SECRET

You have been offered a recording contract in the city and plan to leave the Hollow next month. You were going to tell everyone after the ball.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were alone on the musicians' balcony, tuning up and rehearsing the parade march. From up there you could see the stage line-up the whole time.

YOUR GOALS

- Confirm who stood in the line-up.
- Keep your city plans quiet until Round 3.
- Get the room to hum the Candlewick march.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

From the musicians' balcony you could see the stage all through the line-up rehearsal. You were alone up there from 8:20 to 8:50. Vesper told the band last month that the museum would have "recorded music only."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "How many hems did you pin tonight?"

? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Did you see the Lantern Ghost from outside?"

YOUR TASK

> Hum or whistle a tune, and see who joins in.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confirm what you saw from the balcony: Darcy and Briar never left the stage line between 8:30 and 8:45. You could not see the Lantern Gallery from the balcony; its doors were shut.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Why was the gallery door closed while you were in there?"

? Ask **Bexley Applegate:** "Did Vesper drink from the urn or the gallery kettle?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who was NOT in the ballroom between 8:30 and 8:45.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the city recording contract. You would never have hurt Vesper: you were leaving anyway. Then add that at 8:48 you saw the lantern glide past the windows dead straight, like a bead on a string.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Is your fox mask the only one at the ball?"

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did you hear the band down in the Dipping Room?"

YOUR TASK

> Vote for Best Costume before you vote on the murder.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

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11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

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21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 19

Larkin Hearthstone

BAKER OF THE CANDLEWICK PUMPKIN PIES

"Twenty-four pumpkin pies, one oven, and not a single minute to spare."



FOR LARKIN HEARTHSTONE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 10+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A white or striped apron, a sprinkle of flour on your sleeves and a rolling pin.

Mask: a pumpkin-pie mask: a paper plate painted orange with a crimped edge.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks. You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper planned to give the museum café to a city bakery. Your pie stall at the ball would end.

YOUR SECRET

This year twelve of the twenty-four pies came from the supermarket. Your oven broke on Tuesday and you were too proud to say so.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:15 to 8:55 you were alone in the kitchen, slicing pies. The kitchen is on the far side of the front hall, nowhere near the Back Stairs.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the supermarket pies quiet until Round 3.
- Prove the kitchen is nowhere near the gallery.
- Hand out (pretend) pie to anyone who answers your questions.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were alone in the kitchen from 8:15 to 8:55, slicing twenty-four pumpkin pies for ten o'clock. The kitchen is across the front hall, nowhere near the Back Stairs. You heard the shouts about the Lantern Ghost at 8:48.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Were this year's pumpkins as good as last year's?"

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Who did you see in the gallery?"

YOUR TASK

> Offer everyone a (pretend) slice of pie, and note who refuses.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Vesper planned to hand the museum café to a city bakery, which would end your pie stall. You were cross, but you were going to argue, not anything worse. At 8:00 Vesper told you, "I must have it out with someone before nine."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did Vesper "have it out" with you today?"

? Ask **Bexley Applegate:** "Who fills the gallery kettle?"

YOUR TASK

> Find two people whose stories don't match.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the supermarket pies. Then say this: the Back Stairs come out right beside the Coat Room and the gallery kettle. Anyone coming up from the workshop floor could grab a mask and a cup in under a minute.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Was the Coat Room busy around 8:25?"

? Ask **Corin Thimble:** "Did you see anyone leave the ballroom between 8:30 and 8:45?"

YOUR TASK

Bake a theory: tell one person exactly how you think it was done.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

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21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 20

Teagan Bramwell

GROUNDSKEEPER OF CANDLEWICK HALL



"You hold a ring of forty keys. Tonight one door bothered you."

FOR TEAGAN BRAMWELL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 11+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A barn coat or padded vest, work gloves and a big ring of keys (any keys will do).

Mask: a green leaf mask cut from card, like a hedge.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

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THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks. You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

The town will run the museum with its own staff. You may lose the job you have held for fifteen years.

YOUR SECRET

Your forty keys include the Back Stairs door, but you lost that one key a month ago and have not dared to tell Vesper.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were at the front gate with a lantern, waving in latecomers. You came up the drive at 8:50 and heard about the ghost.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the lost key quiet until Round 2.
- Work out who uses the Back Stairs door.
- Keep your job.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were at the front gate from 8:20 to 8:50 with a lantern, guiding latecomers in. From the gate you could see the terrace lights but not the gallery windows. You know every door in the Hall.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Why did you ask me for the terrace stepladder this afternoon?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did Vesper say anything to you about the staff?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who has their own key to the Back Stairs door.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Admit that you lost your Back Stairs key a month ago. So tonight the only working keys to that door are Darcy's, Marlo's and Perry's. Also: the Back Stairs door was propped open with a wax block when you checked it at 7:45.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Was that your wax block holding the Back Stairs door open?"

? Ask **Auden Pryor:** "Did anyone come into the library between 8:20 and 8:50?"

YOUR TASK

> Get one person to describe the Back Stairs to you.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Say you found the Back Stairs door shut and locked at 9:05, and the wax block was gone. Whoever used those stairs tonight tidied up after themselves.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you ever go downstairs to the workshop floor tonight?"

? Ask **Bexley Applegate:** "Who did you see go toward the gallery?"

YOUR TASK

> Hand your ring of keys to the Detective and ask them to keep it safe.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

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20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 21

Ainsley *Duskwood*

FORTUNE-BOOTH PERFORMER (STAGE ACT ONLY)

"You read fortunes for fun. Tonight nobody laughed."



FOR AINSLEY DUSKWOOD'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 12+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A black cloak or shawl dotted with paper stars, lots of bangles and a scarf tied around your head.

Mask: a silver star mask cut from foil-covered card.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

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THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks. You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper called your fortune booth "nonsense" and said it would not be part of the museum.

YOUR SECRET

Your fortune act is pure guesswork, helped by gossip you hear in the queue. Tonight you told everyone in your queue, "A door will close on someone at nine," because you had overheard gossip about Vesper's announcement.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:15 to 8:50 you sat in the conservatory with your queue of fortune-seekers. Your black cloak never left the booth.

YOUR GOALS

- Prove your black cloak never left the conservatory.
- Keep your "gift" a secret until Round 2.
- Make one dramatic prediction that comes true.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You read fortunes in the conservatory from 8:15 to 8:50 with a queue the whole time. You wear a black cloak, yes, but it never left your booth. All evening you told your queue, "A door will close on someone at nine."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Do you believe in fortunes, and what did Vesper's last one say?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "How many black cloaks did you make this year?"

YOUR TASK

> "Read the palm" of one suspect and predict where they were at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess your secret: the fortunes are guesswork and gossip. Your "door will close at nine" came from queue chatter about Vesper's announcement. Everyone knew something big was coming at nine.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Do you print fortunes in the Gazette?"

? Ask **Corin Thimble:** "What did you see from the balcony?"

YOUR TASK

> Find one person who believes in the Lantern Ghost and one who doesn't.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Say that face paint tells a story too: gold paint rubs onto anything you press against your face. Then make your big prediction: "The truth is downstairs."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Did you ever paint your face this year?"

? Ask **Teagan Bramwell:** "Who uses the Back Stairs most?"

YOUR TASK

> Write your prediction on your ballot and see if it comes true.

Notes

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20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 22

Merritt *Oxley*

TOWN CLERK CARRYING VESPER'S PAPERS

"You carry the papers. You read the papers. You can't say a word about the papers."



FOR MERRITT OXLEY'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 13+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A blazer or neat cardigan, a folder of papers and a fountain pen (any pen) clipped to your pocket.

Mask: a paper mask covered in tiny printed words, cut from an old newspaper.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

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Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

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THE BALL

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

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BACKGROUND

The folder holds the deed of gift: Candlewick Hall goes to the town as the Candlewick Lantern Museum. You helped draw it up.

YOUR SECRET

You privately advised the town council to refuse the gift because the roof repairs would cost a fortune. If Vesper had found out, you would have lost Vesper's trust.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:30 to 8:45 you waited in Vesper's study with the door shut, as Vesper asked. At about 8:35 you heard soft footsteps pass in the gallery toward Vesper's chair and, a minute later, quick footsteps going back toward the Back Stairs.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the deed of gift sealed until Round 2.
- Keep your advice to the council secret until Round 3.
- Find out who walked past the study door.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You carry a sealed folder for Vesper's announcement and can't open it yet. From 8:30 you waited in the study with the door shut. At about 8:35 you heard soft footsteps go past toward Vesper's chair, and a minute later quick footsteps going back toward the Back Stairs.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Were you the footsteps I heard in the gallery?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Do you know what is in my folder?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who was in the Lantern Gallery at 8:35.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Open the folder: it is the deed of gift. Candlewick Hall goes to the town as the Candlewick Lantern Museum, and everything inside will be valued and listed. Anyone hiding something in this house had until November 1.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "What will the museum do with the Dipping Room?"

? Ask **Auden Pryor:** "Is the archive part of the gift?"

YOUR TASK

> Read one line of the deed aloud to the room, in your most official voice.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess that you advised the council to refuse the gift because of the roof. You argued with paperwork, never with Vesper. Point out that the footsteps you heard went toward the Back Stairs, not toward the ballroom.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Were you ever in the gallery tonight?"

? Ask **Teagan Bramwell:** "Who has a key to the Back Stairs door?"

YOUR TASK

> Help the Detective collect every ballot.

Notes

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22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade

CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 23

Wynn Pennywhistle

PHOTOGRAPHER OF THE COSTUME PARADE

"You photograph every costume. Nobody notices the photographer."



FOR WYNN PENNYWHISTLE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 14+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

Dark clothes, a camera on a strap (a phone works) and a beret or cap worn backward.

Mask: a camera-lens mask: a circle of black card with a silver ring.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

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THE BALL

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You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

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BACKGROUND

Vesper refused to let you sell copies of the parade photos and planned to give the museum all your old negatives.

YOUR SECRET

You have been selling the parade photos online anyway, for three years, under another name.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were alone in the portrait room upstairs, setting up lights and a backdrop for the winners' photo. The portrait room is up the main staircase, far from the Back Stairs.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep your photo sales quiet until Round 3.
- Find the best costume of the night.
- Help the Detective with your photographer's eye.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were upstairs in the portrait room from 8:20 to 8:50, setting up the winners' backdrop. You came down the main staircase when you heard shouting about the ghost. Your photographer's eye says: masks hide faces, not walks.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Can I see the Gazette camera photos?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did anyone touch up your gold face paint tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Pick your favorite costume and tell its wearer why.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

In the Gazette photos (Evidence #6), look at Jory's face: no mask, no paint. Masks pick up face paint like a sponge. If you find the fox mask, look inside it.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "How long had you worn your fox mask before you took it off?"

? Ask **Ainsley Duskwood:** "Did your black cloak ever leave the conservatory?"

YOUR TASK

> "Photograph" three suspects (pretend or real) and study their costumes.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the photo sales. Then say that earlier this evening, at about 8:00, you photographed the Dipping Room demonstration: Marlo was wearing a long black cloak and fresh gold face paint dots. At 9:05, when everyone gathered in the ballroom, the dots looked smeared.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Why did your gold face paint look smeared at 9:05?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Who wore the most gold tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Vote for Best Costume, then vote on the murder.

Notes

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